

San Fairy Ann Cycling Club Newsletter

May 2026

Creator Lorna Stafford

What a Month!

What a fantastic few weeks it's been for San Fairy Ann CC.

From racing and touring to the Sportive and time trials, the club has been busy in just about every corner of cycling. We've had members who have won, travelled, volunteered, organised, and represented the club brilliantly.

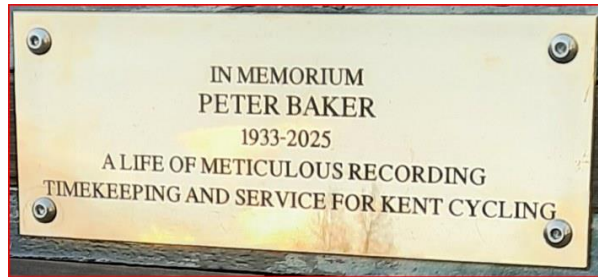
A huge thank you goes to everyone who has helped at events, ridden in club colours, supported fellow members, or just turned up and joined in. It all helps make SFA what it is.

In this month's newsletter:

- Peter Baker - In Memorium
- Member TT success
- SFA Race Team at Cyclopark
- SFA Spain trip
- 2026 Sportive success
- Roy Manser TT information
- How to book the Summer Audax
- Welcome to our new members

Peter Baker - In Memorium

by Mark Vowells



Peter Baker - In Memorium

Further to the announcement in last month's newsletter, a large group of Peter's friends, including many club members, gathered at Bethersden Village Hall on Wednesday 6 May for the unveiling of a plaque in his memory. Peter, an honorary life member of the club, passed away in June last year, aged 91, following a period of ill health.

Geoff Wiles had organised the occasion and he offered a very fine eulogy of Peter's lifetime in the sport, including his meticulous record keeping and timekeeping, as well as his more recent work for Geoff at his bike shop in Strood, after Peter's retirement as an architect. John Hawkrige, President of the Kent Veterans Time Trials Association, spoke of

Peter's diligent work for the VTTA over many years. Then followed Andy Avis, the webmaster of the Fellowship of Kent and Sussex Cyclists, who spoke of his early recollections of Peter from the 1960s and Peter's many racing achievements, including a 1-57 '50'. Peter recorded this time in 1964, when very few riders could beat two hours for a '50'. Others present included Club Chairman Duncan Edwards and Bob Watts, both of whom had cycled from home. Afterward, the party retired to the Rose and Crown, Mundy Bois, for the Wednesday Wobblers lunch. Peter would have approved, as he was also a regular at Wobblers for many years.

Mark Vowells

Wigmore CC Bill Philbrook Memorial 25 Mile Time Trial 03-May-2026.

by Andy Cairns and Barry Fowler





Around 20 riders took on the Wigmore CC Bill Philbrook Memorial 25 on the Q25/15 course along the A20 between Lenham and Ashford. Conditions were good, despite the roads still drying out after some much-needed overnight rain.

Barry Fowler and I were riding in the Road Bike category, which included around half the field, including last week's VTTA (Kent) Group Championship riders.

Barry was off number 13, with me setting off as number 18. It was also the debut outing for my new SFA skinsuit — which performed brilliantly, even if at 89kg I felt a bit more Tinky Winky than Tour de France.

The course rolls constantly, packing around 330 metres of climbing into the 25 miles. I finished in 1:01:42, averaging 39.2 km/h, with an average power of 338 W and a normalized

power of 350 W. That was enough to beat Andrew from VTТА (Kent) by 10 seconds. Barry also had a strong ride on his debut, finishing in 1:05 and comfortably inside his VTТА target.

A fantastic day all round representing SFA, and personally, it felt like one of my strongest rides yet.

SFACC RACING AT THE CYCLOPARK





A great evening was had at Cyclopark, and our boys did us proud. They looked superb in their kit and really stood out from the other riders on the circuit.

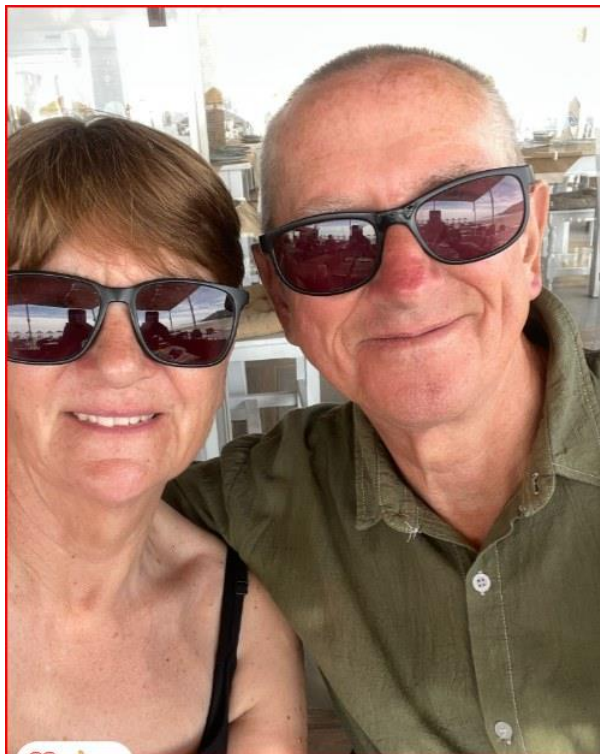
It was great to see so many supporters there, along with members volunteering to marshal, which all helped create a fantastic atmosphere around the event.

If you would like to join the squad, help out, or just support the team at future events, please let Jonathan Leeson know.

SFACC ANNUAL TRIP

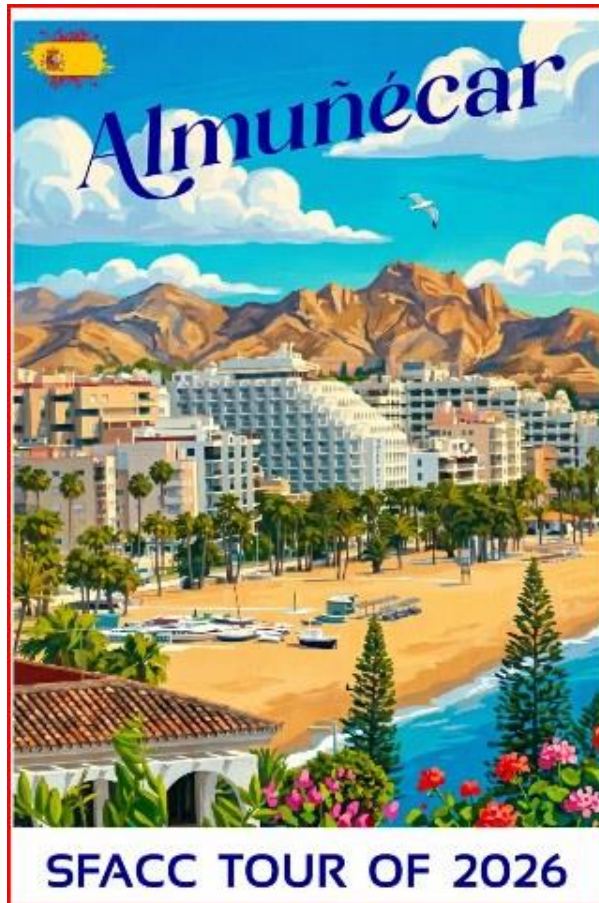
by Lorna Stafford









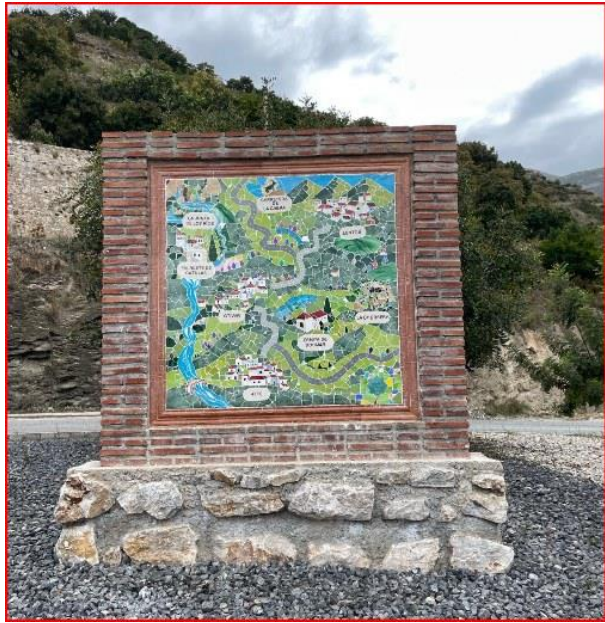


1 - Framed posters can be purchased from Linton.











This year the trip was to Almuñécar, a historic coastal town in Spain's Costa Tropical in the province of Granada.

A group of us travelled by coach from various pick-up points around Maidstone, which made the start of the trip very straightforward. We had expected long delays at Gatwick because of the new identification system, but it was far smoother than anticipated. The flight left on time, and the journey passed comfortably enough.

On arrival, we were met by the Sporta team and directed to our transfer coach for the hour-long journey to the hotel. We stayed at the Hotel Helios Costa Tropical, right opposite the beach, and there were certainly no complaints about the food, plenty of choice, and more than enough of it.

Each evening, we discussed route options with the Sporta staff, who did their best to accommodate everyone's wishes and preferred distances. One thing that could not be avoided, however, was the climbing. Almuñécar sits at the foot of the mountains, so every ride involved a fair amount of ascending before the rewards of the descents back to the coast.

As always, the days disappeared far too quickly, and before long, it was time to head back to a very cold and cloudy UK.

There were a couple of mishaps along the way, including two bikes that were temporarily misplaced, but both were quickly reunited with their owners. Once again, Stephen Harmer and the Sporta+ team did us proud, and we were all looking forward to Portugal in 2027.

2026 SPORTIVE SUCCESS



2 - Rob and Tristen, the 1st one's back on the Darling Buds.

What a day!

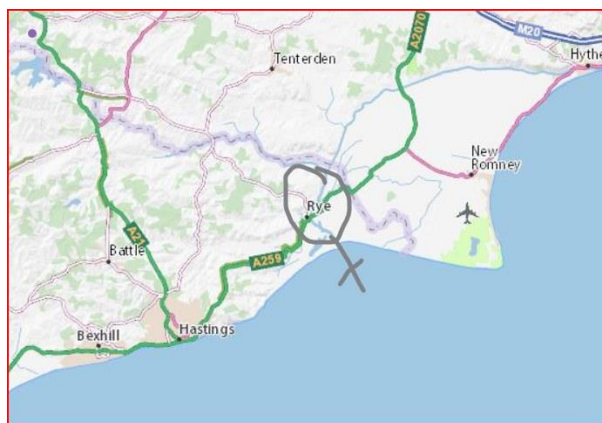
This year's SFA Sportive was another brilliant success, with over 200 riders taking part and a huge number of volunteers helping the event run smoothly from start to finish.

The feedback from riders has been overwhelmingly positive, with many commenting on the organisation, food stops, and friendly atmosphere throughout the day.

A huge thank you for taking part in the 2026 SFA Sportive. We had 204 riders across all routes and abilities, 84 of whom were Club Members, and it was great to see so many people out enjoying the day. We've had lots of positive feedback about the event, the atmosphere, and the organisation, which is very much appreciated by everyone involved behind the scenes. Over the years, the SFACC Sportive has raised more than £60,000 for the Air Ambulance. We are still calculating this year's total, and we hope to continue supporting this vital service for many years to come. Event photos can be viewed and downloaded here:

[PHOTOS GOOGLE DRIVE LINK HERE.](#) We're already planning next year's event on **Sunday, 23rd May 2027**, including slightly earlier start times

Rye and Back Event - Date Announcement - Sunday 31 May.



IT'S NOT TOO LATE!

To join in this year, our Rye and Back event will be held on **Sunday, 31 May**, a week before our Roy Manser Memorial 10-mile time trial.

As long as you are in the **SFACC Strava club** and upload your ride by 6 pm, I think they will be in with a chance. Please email timetrials@sanfairyancc.co.uk and let him know that you will be riding, so he knows who to look out for.

Continuing the revival of the Rye and Back event, we are sticking with the new formula for deciding who gets the two cups we have for this event. The trophies are for solo riders and veteran riders (over 40 years old), as determined by the VTTA Age Adjustments. Follow [this link](#) to the VTTA site to see how the adjustments work, and [this link](#) to the tables that show what the adjustments are; we will use the 25-mile distance.

The event is for solo, unaccompanied riders on standard road bikes (no aero TT bikes allowed), with the shortest total time across 8 timed Strava segments determining who wins.

Full details can be found [HERE](#)

Roy Manser Memorial Open 10 Mile Time Trial - Sunday 7 June 2026, 1st rider starts at 8 am - Helpers Needed



A big thank-you to those who've already offered their time after my earlier call for marshals and helpers; your support is hugely appreciated.

We're still short of a few key roles to make the event run safely and smoothly:

- **Two marshals** are needed for one of the roundabout turns. Without these, we can't meet the risk-assessment requirements, and the event may have to be canceled.
- **Course signage helper** to put up the official *CYCLE EVENT* warning signs before the start. There are around 8–10 signs to be fixed to lamp posts, road signs, or placed on verges. A map and photos show exactly where they go.
- **Finish-line assistant** to help the timekeeper record rider times on a gridded sheet and enter them into the event webpage via mobile phone for display back at HQ.

Full event details can be found [HERE](#).

If you can help with any of these roles, please contact the event secretary, **John Longbottom**, at timetrials@sanfairyancc.co.uk

Thank you again; every bit of help keeps the event alive and safe for everyone.

San Fairy Ann Time Trial Club: Wednesday Evening Series



3 - by Jonathan Leeson

San Fairy Ann Wednesday Evening Time Trials

San Fairy Ann Time Trial Club welcomes riders back for another season of fast, friendly, and competitive Wednesday evening events. Running from **29 April to 5 August**, the series is a key part of the club calendar and a summer highlight for riders of all abilities. **It's not too late to give it a try.**

A Midweek Challenge

The series offers regular racing in a supportive club environment. It's ideal for testing fitness, building confidence, and chasing personal bests.

The Course

Events are planned on the **Q10/29 East Peckham Bypass (10 miles)**, starting at **19:30**. It's a well-established course that provides a fair and consistent test, allowing riders to track progress week by week.

Stay Updated

Please check the club's social media for updates on courses, results, and announcements.

Join Us

With a full summer ahead, the Wednesday series offers plenty of opportunities to get involved. Whether you're chasing a PB or just taking part, we look forward to seeing you on the start line.

Registration opens soon.

Jonathan Leeson

Summer Audax – 28th June! Get It in the Diary

If you're looking for your next bit of two-wheeled fun, circle **28th June** in big bold letters. That's when the **Summer Audax** sets off from **Bethersden Village Hall**, and trust us, you don't want to miss this one.

If you enjoyed the Sportive, the Audax is the perfect next adventure. It's **laid-back, great value**, and packed with that classic "ride, laugh, repeat" energy. All you need to do is follow the route, collect a few clues along the way, and roll back to HQ before the very generous finish time. No pressure, no racing, just a brilliant day out on the bike.

Audaxes are usually ridden solo, but we're fully embracing the **SFA social spirit**. Grab your mates, form a little crew, and turn it into a proper summer outing.

It's friendly, it's fun, and it's the perfect excuse for another day in the saddle. **Get yourself booked in and come enjoy the sunshine with us.**

- 200km Summer Dream
- 150km Summer Holiday
- 100km Summer Swallow
- 50km Summer Breeze
- If you have any questions about these events, please contact Bob Watts at bobwatts999@gmail.com Entry is through the [Audax UK website](#) by selecting a date range that includes 28/6/2026.

Entry

Save the Dates for 2026

- **28th June - Summer Audax - Bethersden Village Hall**
- **6th September - Autumn Audax - Chart Sutton Village Hall**

Member Contributions

Where is everybody????

This newsletter works best when it's **your voices**, not just mine.

If you've:



Been on a Club ride

☕ Discovered a great café (or a terrible one...)

📍 Found a cracking route

📷 Taken photos worth sharing

...then send it in!

It doesn't have to be polished or poetic; **a few lines are plenty**. I can tidy it up if needed (that's my superpower).

If you rode it, ate it, broke it, fixed it, or laughed about it later, **we want to hear about it**.

Sharing is caring. And it saves me from making things up. 😊 So send it to Lorna on WA, or **membership@sanfairynncc.co.uk**

WELCOME ABOARD

A huge welcome to our new members:

David Cole

Autumn Richardson

David Jupp

Rebecca Clifton

Club Contacts

Duncan Edwards - Chair 07402 549927

Jonathan Engwell - Finance 07801 014877

Jonathan Leeson - Information Technology & Racing Team Lead - 07713 318186

Lorna Stafford - Membership & Events 07790 017482

Stephen Harmer - Events/Club Trips 07539 324565

Linton Schwarz - Club Kit 07901 851707

Bob Watts - Sportives & Audax - bobwatts999@gmail.com

Emma Tuffey - Director Of Club Runs & Events - 07976 262260

Veronica Harmer - Club Secretary - 07910 265061

Tony Palmer - Training & Safety - 07786 393838

Wishing you all Safe and Happy Pedalling.